

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1171

By Bailey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of J.T. Bennett, Jr.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of J.T. Bennett, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bennett was a highly respected member of his community and a consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Oak Ridge on October 21, 1945, Mr. Bennett was the son of J.T. Bennett, Sr., and Pearl Wilhite Bennett and a 1964 graduate of Cookeville Central High School; and

WHEREAS, J.T. Bennett honorably served his country as a member of the United States Army; he completed three years of active duty service, including service during the Vietnam War, fulfilling his role as an electronics equipment repairman with honor and distinction; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bennett was duly recognized for his service and earned several commendations, including the National Defense Service Medal, the Vietnam Service Medal, the Vietnam Campaign Medal with 60 Device, and the Army Commendation Medal; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bennett's dedication to civic engagement and community service was reflected in his lifetime memberships with the Veterans of Foreign Wars and the American Legion, both enduring expressions of his bond with his fellow servicemen; and

WHEREAS, following his military service, J.T. Bennett embarked on a notable career with the Cookeville Police Department, beginning in July 1968; he served his community as a law enforcement officer with unwavering devotion for nearly forty years, culminating in his service as captain. He took his much-deserved retirement in 2007; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bennett continued his service to others by working as a funeral assistant at Hooper, Huddleston & Horner Funeral Home for several years, in which role he extended comfort and offered support to families during their most difficult times; and

WHEREAS, J.T. Bennett was also devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his wife of sixty years, Ann Stockton Bennett, whom he married on April 2, 1966; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bennett leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of J.T. Bennett, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Bennett.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.